

RUGUMAHO

A Simple Guide to Growing Your Blog & Media Presence

Prepared for Ariane Rugumaho

1. Writing for Your Readers (Simple Blog SEO)

SEO doesn't have to be technical. At its heart, Google wants to show people high-quality, relevant writing. Here is how to write your posts to naturally attract readers:

- **Make Headlines Descriptive:** Avoid generic titles like *'My Sunday'* or *'Workout Tips'*. Instead, write what people actually search or feel: *'Cultivating Mindful Habits for a Silent Morning'* or *'A Weekend Finding Stillness in Musanze's Valleys'*.
- **Use Clear Subsections:** Break your article up into sections using simple headers. Google reads these headers to understand the structure of your writing.
- **Interlink Your Work:** In every new article you write, include links back to 2 or 3 of your older articles (for example: *'...as I wrote in my post about slow travel...'*). This keeps readers browsing your website longer.
- **Quality Over Quantity:** One beautifully written, deeply personal, and helpful journal entry once a week is far better than publishing short, rushed updates daily.

2. Building Your Substack & WhatsApp Circles

These are your 'high-trust' channels. They let you reach your readers directly without relying on social media algorithms.

- **The Substack Newsletter:** Treat your newsletter as a personal letter. Write a warm, brief greeting and summarize the themes of your latest blog post. Always include a clean, bold link: *'Read the full journal entry on Rugumaho.com'*.
- **WhatsApp Channels:** Set up a public WhatsApp Channel (which keeps phone numbers private). When you publish a post, share a 2-sentence hook + the link. People open WhatsApp immediately, leading to instant traffic.

3. Future Idea: Launching a Podcast & YouTube Channel

Note: The following is a proposed growth concept for when you feel ready to expand. It is not an immediate requirement, but a roadmap showing how you can leverage audio/video if you decide to.

If you choose to create a podcast in the future, YouTube acts as an exceptional search engine to attract listeners who prefer audio and video formats.

A Simple Recording Setup (If you choose to start one)

Should you decide to record audio or video, you can set up a cozy, quiet corner with warm lighting. You don't need professional studio equipment—just a clean smartphone camera and a simple USB microphone to keep your audio crisp and inviting.

Suggested Search-Friendly Episode Titles

If you record episodes, avoid naming them 'Podcast Episode 1'. Instead, title them based on themes your listeners search for:

Proposed Example: 'How to Actually Stay Consistent with Fitness as a Busy Mom | Podcast'

Proposed Example: 'Finding Stillness: My Simple Guide to Mindful Slow Mornings | Podcast'

A Potential Repurposing Flywheel

This is how you can maximize your writing time by splitting a single audio episode into multiple social assets:

Step 1: The Long Video	Upload the full 15–30 minute episode to YouTube for long-term search value.
Step 2: The Shorts	Cut the episode into 3 vertical clips (under 60s) showing key quotes with auto-captions for YouTube Shorts and Instagram Reels.
Step 3: The Write-Up	Embed the YouTube player inside a written blog post on your website so readers can read or listen.

4. A Proposed Podcast Launch Concept (For Future Consideration)

- **Sample Episode 1 Idea:** Introduce yourself and your journey with a topic like 'Why I Decided to Slow Down'. Share why you started the blog and your personal shifts in motherhood and lifestyle.
- **Simple Distribution:** Should you launch, a free distributor like **Spotify for Podcasters** can publish your episodes to Spotify and Apple Podcasts automatically.